Greater Hudson Promise Neighborhood

Program overview · Beyond GED · greaterhudsonpromise.org

Why Hudson

28.2%
of Hudson residents live below the poverty line — more than double Columbia County's 12.1%

1 in 10
Hudson residents were displaced by urban renewal north of Warren Street

80%+
of people arrested for marijuana possession in New York were Black or Latino

Hudson's working-class and Black families have absorbed one policy blow after another. In the late 1960s and early '70s, urban renewal cleared more than 50 acres of the North Bay, a working-class neighborhood by the waterfront, north of Warren Street, and the most racially diverse in the city. More than 200 families, nearly 850 people, were displaced.

The same project shaped the city still visible today. North of Warren, homes were bulldozed and public housing went up in their place, including the nine-story Bliss Towers. On Warren Street, the historic houses were saved: the city restored them with federal urban renewal money, and in 1973 Hudson became the first city in the country to receive federal funds for historic rehabilitation through facade easements. Those restored blocks are the Warren Street visitors know today.

Homeownership has long been the main way American families build wealth to pass down, and for decades Black families were largely kept out of it: the Federal Housing Administration refused to insure mortgages in or around Black neighborhoods. In New York today, 67% of white households own their homes, compared with 32% of Black households.

Then came the War on Drugs. New York's drug laws and cannabis prohibition were enforced hardest on Black and Latino New Yorkers. An arrest could cost a job, an apartment, or a place in school, and the damage carried into the next generation.

Today Warren Street is a destination for galleries, restaurants, and now dispensaries. North of Warren is home to nearly all of the city's subsidized housing and most of its Black residents; in 2018, 28.8% of residents there were Black, compared with 13.3% south of Warren. Hudson's median household income is $54,139, against $81,528 for Columbia County and $85,974 statewide, and more than one in four residents lives in poverty. Young people leave school to work and support their families, and too many are pulled into the justice system.

> “There was probably about 90 percent of the stores on Warren Street I had never, ever stepped inside… There wasn’t anybody that worked there that you recognized or looked like you. It was just like Warren Street was a separate city from the rest of Hudson.”
>
> — Kamal Johnson, Hudson’s first Black mayor, 2020

You don’t have to be in Hudson for this to be your community’s story. The same state and federal policies hit Black neighborhoods across New York. Hudson is where a proven program is already turning that history around, and where your Community Impact Plan can show measurable results.

About Greater Hudson Promise Neighborhood

Greater Hudson Promise Neighborhood has been part of Hudson since 2011. That year it was one of fifteen communities in the country selected for a U.S. Department of Education Promise Neighborhoods planning grant, the Obama Administration’s initiative modeled on the Harlem Children’s Zone. Today GHPN is an independent 501(c)(3), led since its 2011 beginnings by Joan Hunt, now Executive Director, with a team that includes staff with lived experience and represents the community it serves.

Its home is a renovated historic building in the heart of the city, where children and adults take part in daily programming or seek individual support. 364 Warren Street, which operated as a jail and courthouse from 1805 to 1835, now serves, fittingly, as a community hub and headquarters for programs that provide opportunities and support to families and individuals impacted by systemic oppression and failures.

GHPN offers a pipeline of free programming from cradle through career: early learning for babies and toddlers, after-school for school-age kids, Beyond GED for young adults, and emergency aid, guaranteed-income support, and support for individuals and families impacted by the criminal legal system. Since 2020, GHPN has expanded its programs and significantly increased its reach, and its annual revenue has grown from about $138,000 in 2020 to $2.3 million in 2024. In 2025 alone, GHPN distributed $350,170 in emergency assistance to Columbia County residents, helped divert 90 evictions, administered $730,000 in guaranteed income to City of Hudson residents through the HudsonUP pilot, and hosted community-building events in the City of Hudson with 400+ attendees.

Since 2011 serving Hudson families	**$2.3M** annual revenue (2024)	**$350K+** emergency assistance to Columbia County residents (2025)
800+ child-friendly jail visits for 90+ families since 2016	**128** Hudson residents served in the HudsonUP pilot run by GHPN	**90** evictions diverted through rent assistance (2025)

Milestones

2011	Selected for a federal Promise Neighborhood planning grant
2014	After-school program opens
2015	Greater Hudson Initiative for Children of Incarcerated Parents (GHICIP) launches
2016	Enhanced Child Visit Program launches full-contact, child-friendly visiting at the Columbia County Jail
2020	HudsonUP guaranteed income pilot launches (first of three cohorts)
2020	Becomes an independent 501(c)(3)
2021	Promise Early Learning launches for children ages 0–5
2022	Beyond GED launches for Opportunity Youth ages 16–24
2025	County-wide guaranteed income pilot launches for single caregivers of children under 6; $350,170 in emergency aid, including groceries for 760+ residents during the SNAP lapse
2026	Childcare Works launches to train new early educators

Your focus: Beyond GED

Paid GED and career pathways for Opportunity Youth

Beyond GED serves Opportunity Youth — young people 16 to 24 who are out of school and out of work. It was built from interviews with its first cohort, who named poverty as the main reason they left school: they were working to support themselves or their families.

So the program pays them to learn. Enrolled students receive a paid stipend for hours with a tutor, a hot meal on study days, internship and job placement, and a dedicated staff member who builds an individualized plan around whatever stands in the way — IDs, court dates, housing, transportation, mental health.

Many participants facing serious felony charges avoided prison and moved into higher education or employment instead.

12
students have earned their GED since launch

16
participants gained employment in 2025

0	25
completers have re-entered the justice system	Opportunity Youth enrolled in 2025/2026

> “One of the best decisions I've made for my future.”
> — Beyond GED student

> “It's been heaven sent for my child, and without this program I am not sure where my son would be.”
> — Beyond GED parent

Learn more

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Tax status	Greater Hudson Promise Neighborhood is a registered 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. Contributions are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law, and GHPN will send a written acknowledgment of each contribution for your tax records. EIN 85-0949720.

Sources

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Further reading

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